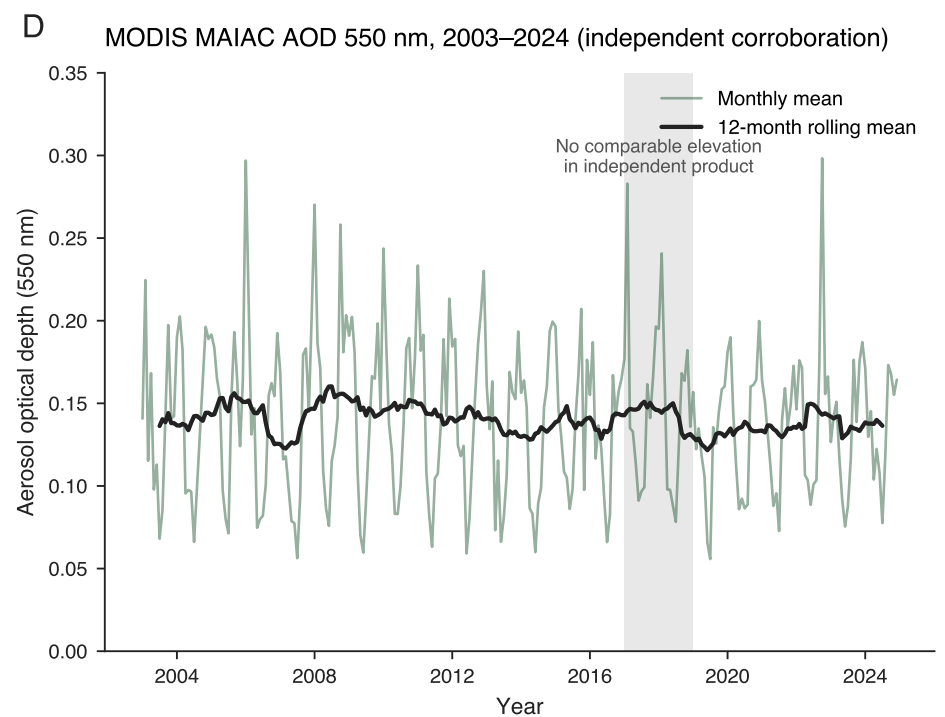
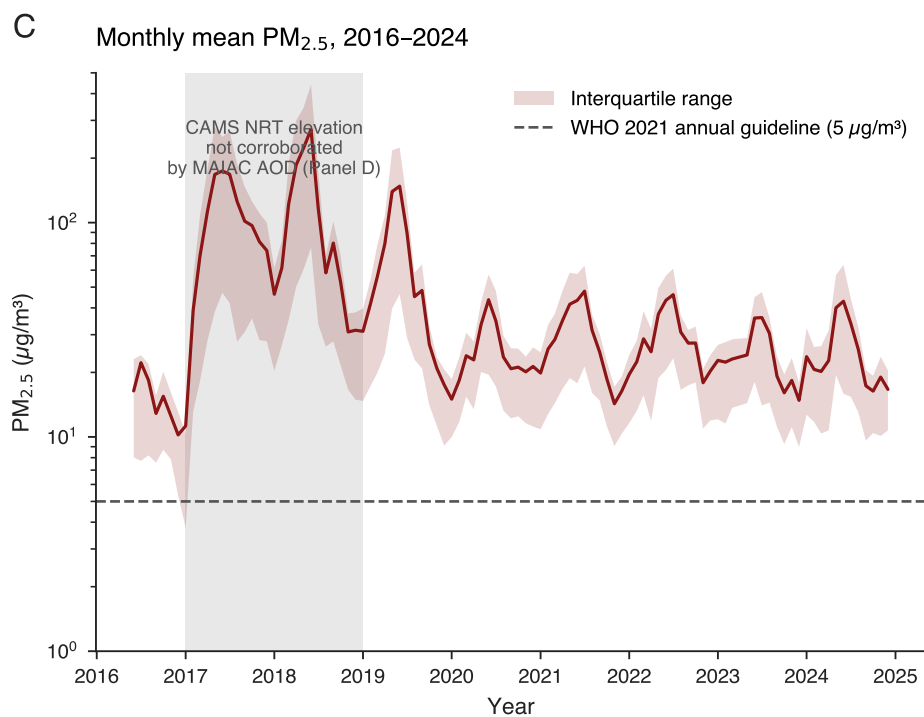
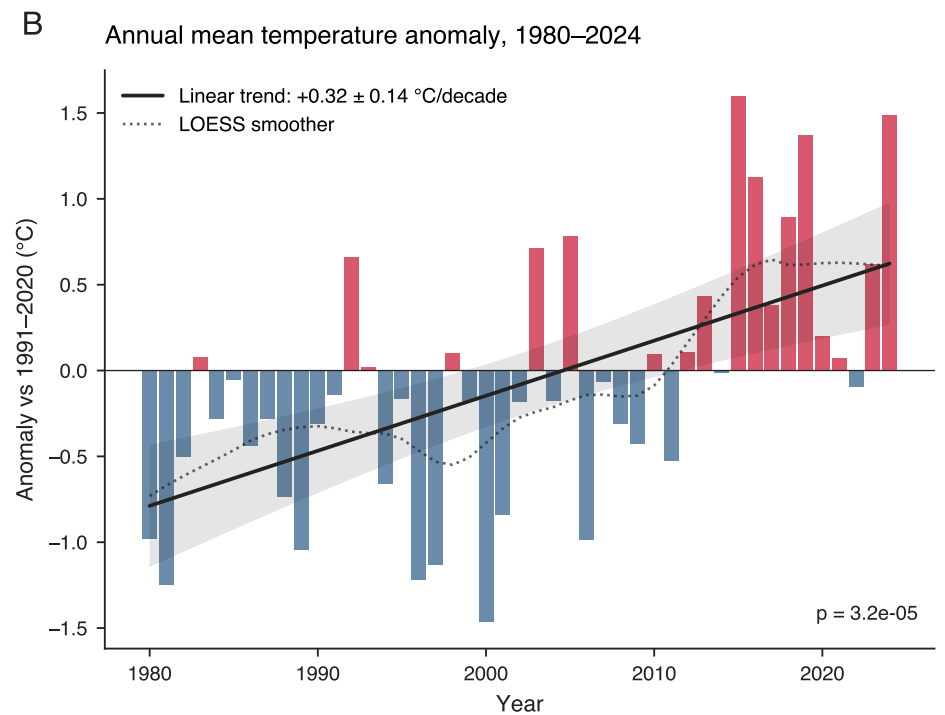
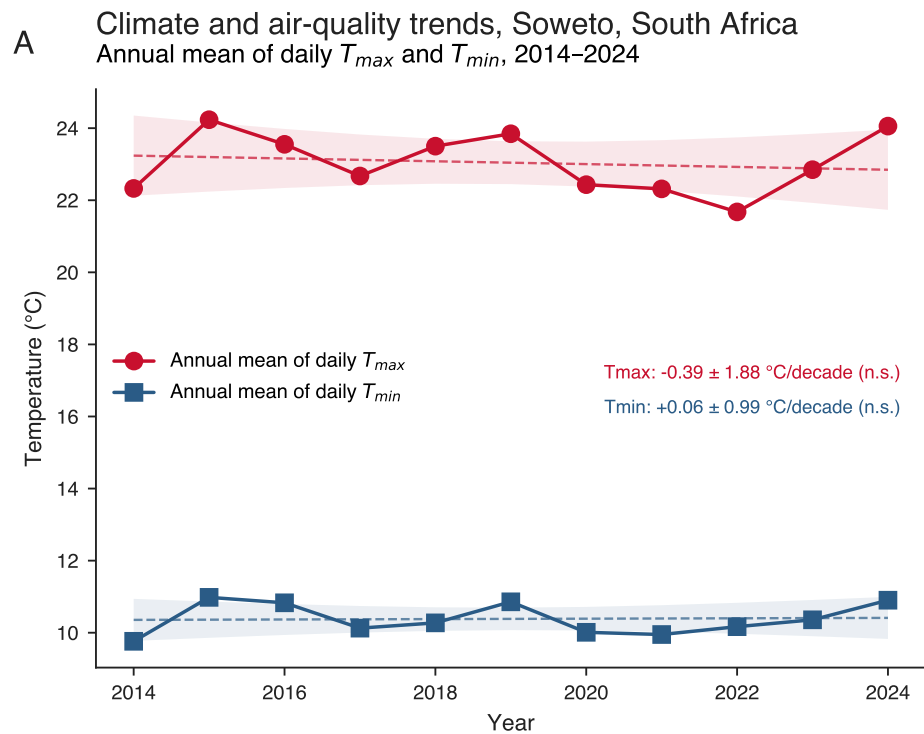




Data sources A–B: ERA5-Land reanalysis (Copernicus C3S/ECMWF). C: CAMS NRT global forecast (Copernicus Atmosphere Monitoring Service). D: MODIS MCD19A2 MAIAC AOD v6.1 (NASA LP DAAC).

Extracted at Soweto -26.27 °S, 27.86 °E with a 5 km buffer. Figure prepared 2026-05-11. See MANUSCRIPT_FIGURES.md for assumptions and limitations.